Make sure you add the greens at the last minute, otherwise they will overcook and the soup will lose its fresh taste and bright green color.

spinach and rosemary soup

SERVES 6 **PREP** 15 MINS **COOK** 25 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS

3½ tbsp butter
4oz (115g) finely chopped onion
5½oz (150g) diced potato
salt and freshly ground black pepper
2 cups hot vegetable stock, chicken stock, or water
2 cups creamy milk (¼ cream and ¾ milk)
12oz (350g) spinach, stalks removed and chopped
1 tbsp chopped fresh rosemary
2 tbsp half-and-half, to garnish
sprig of rosemary or rosemary flowers, to garnish

1 Melt the butter in a heavy-bottomed saucepan. When it is starting to foam, add the onion and potato, and stir to coat well. Season with salt and freshly ground black pepper, then cover the pan with a lid and cook the vegetables over low heat for 10 minutes.

2 Add the stock and milk, bring to a boil, then simmer for 5 minutes or until the potato and onion are completely cooked. Add the spinach and boil the soup with the lid off for 2–3 minutes or until tender. Do not overcook. Add the chopped rosemary, then process the soup in a blender until smooth. You may need to do this in batches. Return to the pan and reheat gently.

3 Serve in warm bowls garnished with a swirl of half-and-half and a sprig of rosemary. If you have a rosemary bush in bloom, sprinkle a few flowers over the top for extra pizzazz. This is good with crusty bread.